Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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LEARNER GUIDE

For

Microsoft Copilot for Powerpoint Masterclass

Course Code: C012

Conducted by

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How to Use This Guide

This guide supports Microsoft Copilot for Powerpoint Masterclass (C012), a one-day course. Use it with the visual course deck and the individual activity folders. The slides explain concepts and show worked examples; this guide carries the detailed procedures. Each activity folder is self-contained with Microsoft 365 Copilot prompts, mock CSV/Excel data, editable PowerPoint files and verification evidence.

PowerPoint and Copilot interfaces can change. Follow the intent and verify the current control name if your version differs. Use only approved accounts and synthetic or approved data in AI services.

Before class:

- Install or update Microsoft PowerPoint and Excel or confirm Microsoft 365 web access.
- Download the complete activities folder from the LMS or GitHub repository.
- Confirm that every activity folder contains INSTRUCTIONS.md, CHECKLIST.md, PROMPTS.md, CSV, XLSX and PPTX files.
- Keep the original evidence files unchanged; save a named working copy for each activity.

Microsoft 365 Premium Training Account Access

The trainer assigns each learner a Microsoft 365 Premium training account through a private credential card or channel. Usernames and passwords are intentionally not printed in this guide, the slide deck or the public learner repository.

- Obtain your assigned account from the trainer, then open https://m365.cloud.microsoft/
- Sign in with only the account allocated to you and use approved or synthetic activity data.
- Open Microsoft 365 Copilot, choose Create, select Design an infographic, and enter the prompt from your activity folder.
- Download and verify your infographic or PowerPoint working file using the activity naming convention.
- Never change the shared account password, recovery email, security information or multi-factor authentication settings; never share the credentials.
- When finished, sign out of Microsoft 365 and close the browser. If the infographic option is unavailable, inform the trainer and use the supplied editable PowerPoint starter.

Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Draw insights from infographics to make data-driven decisions.
- LO2: Leverage PowerPoint infographics for articulating data insights to stakeholders.

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- LO3: Assess the effectiveness of PowerPoint infographics based on allocated resources in accordance with business goals.

Infographic Foundations

An infographic combines concise text, data and visual structure to help an audience understand important information and relationships. A useful infographic is not merely attractive; it answers a question and supports an appropriate decision or action.

Audience question	Useful infographic form	Typical evidence
What changed over time?	Chronology or timeline	Dates, milestones, trend values
How does it work?	Instructional process, cycle or roadmap	Stages, sequence, inputs and outputs
Which option differs?	Comparison or statistical infographic	Comparable metrics and consistent units
How are parts organised?	Hierarchy, tree or mind map	Levels, categories and relationships
What numbers matter?	Statistical dashboard or big-number story	Definitions, denominators, timeframe and source

Insight extraction

- What it shows — State visible values, differences, trends and exceptions.
- What it may mean — Offer a plausible interpretation without implying unsupported causation.
- Why it matters — Connect the pattern to the audience's business question.
- What to do — Recommend a proportionate next step and name uncertainty or evidence gaps.

AI-First Data-to-Infographic Workflow

The default modern workflow is not to construct a full infographic manually from a blank slide. Use approved AI tools to accelerate source organisation, data cleanup, analysis, insight extraction and first-draft visual generation. Use Excel and the original sources to verify evidence, then use PowerPoint as the editable refinement, presentation and release layer.

Collect — Approved files, URLs, transcripts and datasets; record origin and access date.

Clean — Remove duplicates, standardise units and labels, identify missing values and retain the raw source.

Analyse — Ask AI for patterns, exceptions and comparisons, then reproduce critical calculations in Excel.

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Extract — Write show–mean–matter–act insights with citations, caveats and forbidden claims.

Generate — In Microsoft 365 Copilot, choose Create > Design an infographic, describe the output, optionally add approved content, choose brand and orientation, then generate.

PowerPoint — Download or rebuild in PPTX; restore editability, charts, source labels, brand and accessibility.

Verify — Compare every claim to source, record prompts and human changes, approve and export.

Data and insight verification gate

- Keep the untouched raw source and create a source register before cleanup.
- Require AI to list proposed transformations, missing data, conflicting definitions and assumptions.
- Reproduce decision-critical totals, percentages, differences and trends with Excel formulas.
- Separate observation from interpretation; add caveats, confidence and forbidden claims.
- Treat AI as an assistant, not as the source of truth or final owner.

Copy-ready prompt patterns

Analyse the evidence — Using only the attached approved source, identify the three strongest patterns, the denominator for each metric, one limitation and one proportionate business action. Cite the source field or row for every number. Do not invent missing values or imply causation.

Create the infographic — Create a one-page [TYPE] infographic about [TOPIC]. Sections: 1. [SECTION ONE] 2. [SECTION TWO] 3. [SECTION THREE] 4. [SECTION FOUR] 5. [SECTION FIVE]. Audience: [AUDIENCE]. Decision: [DECISION]. Style: professional, high contrast, concise, accessible and aligned to [BRAND]. Use only the approved attached content. Include source and period. Do not invent data.

Refine in PowerPoint — Turn the selected infographic direction into one editable PowerPoint slide. Keep the action title, labels, numbers, chart or process, source footer and accessibility notes editable. Remove decoration that does not support the message. Apply the approved brand colours and preserve one clear reading path.

Quality review — Review this infographic against message clarity, data accuracy, visual hierarchy, audience fit, accessibility, editability and business goal. List each issue with evidence, its impact, the proposed change and a pass/fail acceptance check. Do not rewrite verified facts.

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PowerPoint Design System

Design decision	Use in PowerPoint	Quality check
Canvas	Design > Slide Size > Custom Slide Size	Output orientation and channel are defined
Grid	View > Ruler, Gridlines and Guides	Margins and spacing are consistent
Shapes	Insert > Shapes; merge, align, distribute and group	One visual grammar supports the relationship
Icons and images	Insert > Icons or Stock Images	Relevant, consistent, labelled and permitted
Typography	One heading family, one body family, few sizes	Readable hierarchy; no cramped paragraphs
Colour	Restrained palette with one purposeful accent	Meaning does not rely on colour alone
SmartArt	Process, cycle, list, hierarchy or timeline	Structure fits; editability is retained
Charts	Native PowerPoint chart or embedded/linked Excel	Action title, direct labels, units and source are visible

Microsoft 365 Copilot Infographic Creation

The Microsoft 365 Copilot app can create an infographic from a detailed description and, where available, approved uploaded content. Learners can choose Brand and color, select Portrait or Wide, generate alternatives, then copy, edit or download the result. Copilot in PowerPoint can add, restructure and refine slide content. Availability depends on licence, region, administrator settings and current product rollout.

Current Microsoft workflow

Describe — State type, topic, sections, audience, decision, style and source constraints.

Add content — Upload only approved content when the feature and policy allow it.

Brand and color — Use an approved brand kit or a controlled palette.

Orientation — Choose Portrait for one-page reading or Wide for a presentation slide.

Create — Generate options, inspect the result and keep the strongest direction.

Edit or download — Correct facts, refine hierarchy and bring the accountable master into PowerPoint.

Structured sample prompt

The prompt below follows the user-supplied example and adds audience, decision, accessibility and source controls.

```
Create a one-page process infographic about cybersecurity awareness.
```


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```
Sections:

1. Common threats

2. Phishing examples

3. Safe password practices

4. Multi-factor authentication

5. Reporting suspicious activity

Audience: office employees

Decision: recognise, avoid and report suspicious activity

Style: professional, high contrast and accessible

Source rule: use only the attached approved policy; do not invent facts
```

Prompt anatomy

Prompt field	What to specify	Verification question
Type and topic	Timeline, process, comparison, statistical, hierarchy, mind map or scorecard	Does the form match the relationship?
Sections	Ordered content blocks with direct labels	Does each section earn space?
Audience and decision	Who will use the visual and what they must decide or do	Can the audience state the action?
Style and format	Professional, brand, contrast, Portrait or Wide	Does the channel fit the output?
Source rule	Approved attachment, period, scope and forbidden claims	Can every claim be traced?

Human review gate

- Truth — verify every number, label, source and implied relationship.
- Privacy — use only approved data and services; do not upload personal or restricted information.
- Rights — confirm template, image, icon, font and generated-asset permissions.
- Accessibility — check reading order, contrast, direct labels, text size and alt text.
- Brand — apply the approved master, palette, logo, tone and ownership.
- Editability — rebuild decision-critical evidence as native objects and test export.

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Workplace Infographic Demonstration Gallery

The course deck contains twelve editable demonstration infographics. Each uses realistic workplace decisions with synthetic training data so learners can study the visual mechanism without mistaking the example for operational evidence.

Infographic type	Workplace use case	Decision or action
Statistical dashboard	Retail customer experience	Test a first-purchase onboarding message before changing the full service model.
Comparison	Category promotion decision	Use Ready Meals as the next campaign test while monitoring returns.
Timeline	Employee onboarding	Move account provisioning to the pre-boarding week.
Process	Cybersecurity awareness	Make the reporting step visible beside every email client shortcut.
Cycle	Service improvement	Close each monthly cycle with one owned experiment.
Funnel	SaaS adoption	Reduce the steps between sign-up and first successful task.
Hierarchy	Strategy communication	Show ownership and review cadence below every business goal.
Mind map	Stakeholder communication	Keep one core claim, then vary depth by audience.
Geographic	Store operations	Pilot queue redesign in the West region before network-wide rollout.
Before and after	Operations redesign	Standardise the five-step flow and audit exceptions for four weeks.
Resource scorecard	LO3 tool investment	Fund the workflow with quarterly accuracy and accessibility reviews.
Decision matrix	Channel selection	Use Wide for the briefing and export a separate Portrait handout.

Review and Resource Decisions

Review an infographic against observed audience outcomes and the six dimensions below. Feedback should describe what is visible, ask about the objective, connect the issue to a principle and propose one testable improvement.

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Dimension	Review question
Message clarity	Can the audience state the intended takeaway and action?
Data integrity	Are values, units, context, source and uncertainty accurate?
Visual hierarchy	Is the reading order obvious and purposeful?
Accessibility	Are contrast, labels, text size, alt text and non-colour cues adequate?
Engagement	Does the visual earn attention without chart junk or decoration?
Business and resource fit	Does it support the decision, channel, budget, workflow and governance needs?

LU1 — AI-Assisted Infographic Planning and Data Insights

Purpose · Types · Audience · Metrics · Planning · Insight extraction

Key concepts

- An infographic combines concise text, data, shapes, colour, charts and icons to reveal information and relationships.
- Chronology, timeline, process, comparison, statistical, mind map, numerical and hierarchical formats answer different questions.
- A Copilot-first workflow gathers approved sources, cleans and analyses data, extracts candidate insights, then routes verified evidence into visual generation.
- Insight extraction distinguishes what the chart shows, what it means, why it matters and what action is justified.

Activity 1 — Interpret a Statistical KPI Infographic

Objective: Interpret a statistical kpi infographic, verify its denominators and convert visible patterns into defensible business decisions.

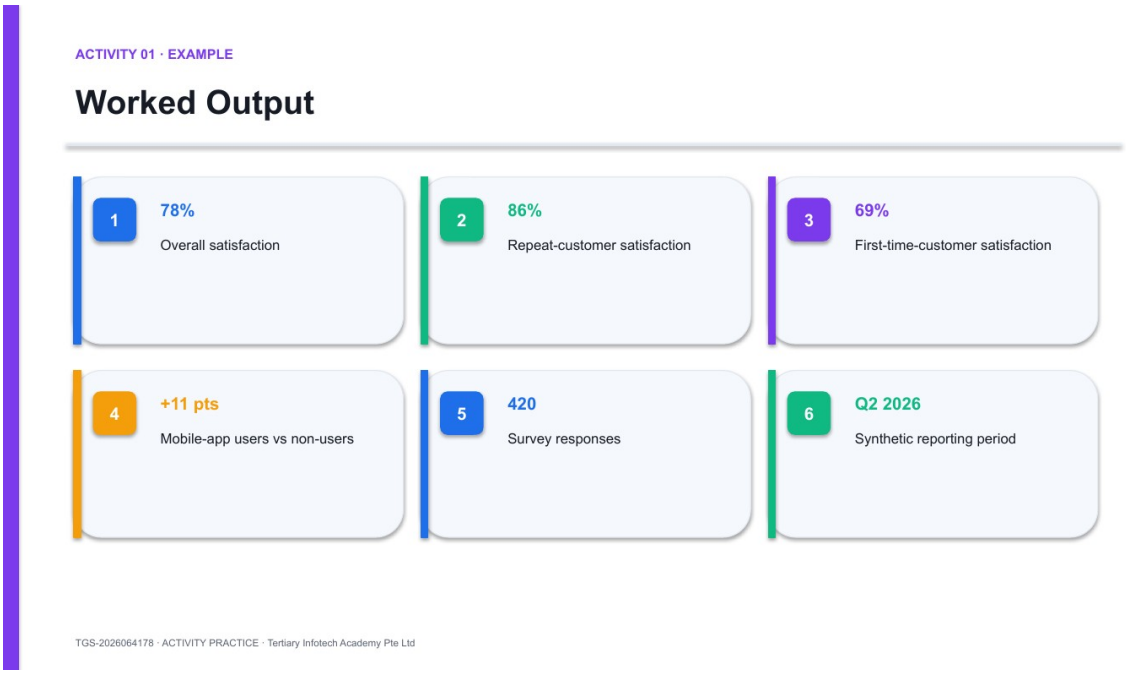
Output: A verified statistical KPI infographic, prompt/source log, annotated insight slide and one-sentence recommendation (35 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar Retail's marketing lead has a one-page customer survey infographic built from 420 synthetic Q2 responses. Leadership wants to know which customer experience deserves further investigation.

Use Microsoft 365 Copilot with the supplied approved data summary to propose candidate insights. Verify every number in Excel before recommending one next step.

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Activity 1 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Register the sources —** Open the A01 XLSX, CSV and Source Notes sheet. In the AI Prompt Lab record each source, its period, data status, owner and permitted use before uploading anything.
2. **Preserve the raw data —** Save a named working copy. Do not modify or replace the raw CSV; perform cleanup on a separate worksheet or in an approved AI session.
3. **Run the data-cleaning prompt —** Copy the Analyse the evidence prompt from PROMPTS.md into Microsoft 365 Copilot. Ask it to flag duplicates, missing values, inconsistent labels, units and periods and to describe every proposed transformation. Require no invented values.
4. **Verify the cleanup —** Compare the AI response with the raw CSV. Apply only justified changes in the workbook, retain a before/after note and confirm the response count remains 420.
5. **Ask for candidate insights —** Request the largest, smallest, gap, exception and competing explanation. Require each candidate insight to cite the exact rows or source fields used.
6. **Reproduce the calculations —** Use the Analysis sheet and Excel formulas to reproduce every critical difference or percentage. Reject any AI claim that cannot be reproduced.

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7. **Write the insight chain —** Complete What it shows; What it may mean; Why it matters; What action is justified. Add one caveat or confidence note.

8. **Build the PowerPoint evidence —** Open the A01 start PPTX, save a working copy, add one editable annotation and show Synthetic Northstar Retail data, Q2 2026, n=420 in the source footer.

9. **Complete the prompt log —** Record the AI tool, full prompt, approved inputs, output reviewed, rejected claims, human changes, reviewer and final owner.

Test it

Change one value in a named workbook copy. Recalculate the insight and confirm the PowerPoint claim, source note and caveat still agree.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Review the question and evidence definitions
8 min	Read values and denominators
12 min	Build the insight chain and annotation
7 min	Peer challenge and revision
3 min	Save and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Observation uses visible values and correct units
- Interpretation is labelled as interpretation, not fact
- Source, timeframe and sample size are visible
- Action is proportionate to the evidence
- Editable PPTX opens without repair

Discussion and debrief

- What is the strongest visible pattern?
- Which denominator or segment could change the interpretation?
- What can be said confidently, and what cannot?
- What business action is proportionate to the evidence?

Debrief standard: The final insight clearly separates what the data shows, what it may mean, why it matters and what should happen next.

Activity 2 — Design a Comparison Infographic Brief

Objective: Turn verified insights into a structured microsoft 365 copilot brief for a comparison infographic that controls audience, message, evidence and output.

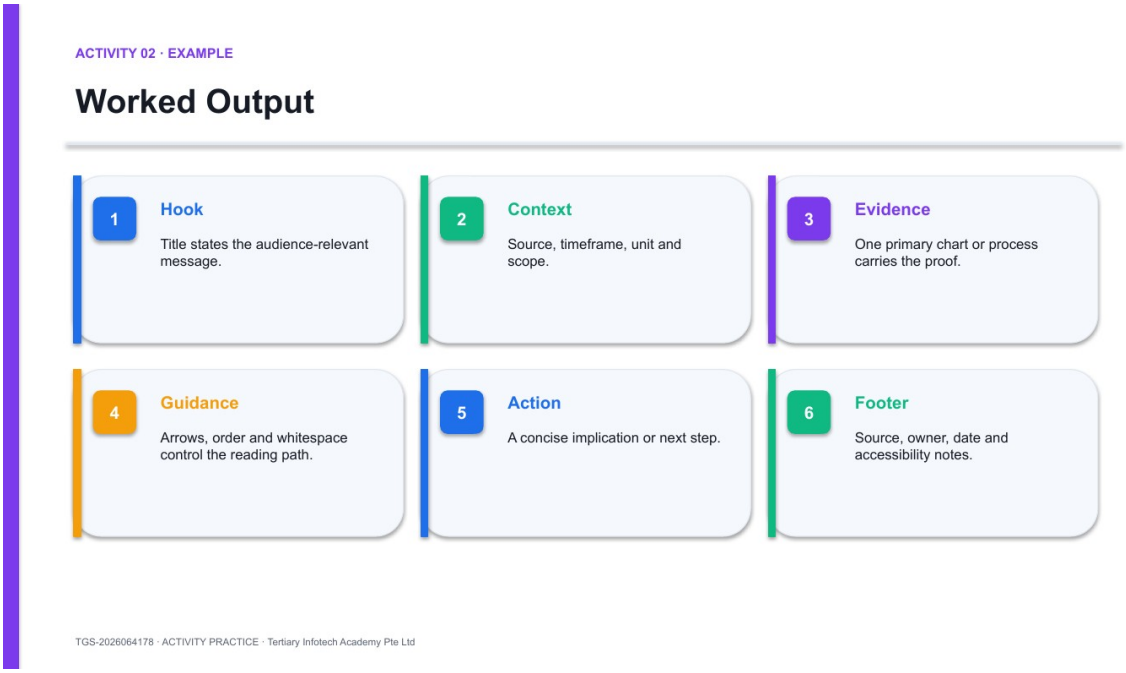
Output: A structured Copilot prompt, two comparison-infographic directions and one approved PowerPoint wireframe (35 minutes).

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Scenario

Northstar plans a sustainable-delivery campaign. The communication manager needs a portrait infographic showing the customer journey from order to low-emission delivery.

Use the supplied structured prompt workbook to ask Microsoft 365 Copilot for two comparison-infographic directions. Select one by evidence fit, then preserve it as the control brief for PowerPoint.



Activity 2 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Open the brief and prompt pack —** Open the A02 workbook, PROMPTS.md and start PPTX. Save named working copies and select only the verified A01 insight chain as input.
2. **Define the control brief —** Complete Audience, Business question, Desired action, Success evidence, approved claims, forbidden claims, output channel and owner.
3. **Choose the infographic form —** Select timeline, process, comparison, statistical, hierarchy or hybrid. Explain why it reveals the relationship better than two alternatives.
4. **Write the structured prompt —** Use the prompt anatomy in the workbook: role, audience, objective, approved evidence, hierarchy, format, brand, accessibility, constraints and output.

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5. **Request two directions —** Ask Microsoft 365 Copilot for two low-fidelity comparison-infographic directions. Require labelled content zones, source space and no invented data or imagery.
6. **Score the directions —** Compare both options for question fit, hierarchy, evidence space, reading order, accessibility and ease of PowerPoint refinement.
7. **Build the approved wireframe —** In PowerPoint set a portrait canvas, turn on guides and recreate only the selected direction with editable grey placeholders.
8. **Test the reading path —** Zoom to 25 percent. Ask a peer to point to first, second and last. Move or simplify blocks until the intended order is consistent.
9. **Record the decision —** Capture the chosen direction, rejected option, prompt, removed content, intended channel, accessibility risks, reviewer and owner.

Test it

Show the wireframe at 25% zoom for five seconds. Ask a peer to identify the first, second and final reading points without coaching.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Complete the brief
5 min	Choose and justify the form
15 min	Build the portrait wireframe
7 min	Test the reading path
3 min	Save and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Audience question and action are explicit
- Infographic form matches the relationship
- Wireframe works without colour
- Reading order is obvious at thumbnail size
- Space exists for source and accessibility notes

Discussion and debrief

- What is the single audience question?
- Which infographic type best reveals the relationship?
- What content should be removed?
- Where should the reader's eye land first, second and last?

Debrief standard: The wireframe communicates objective, hierarchy, evidence, flow, action and source space before visual styling begins.

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LU2 — Creating PowerPoint Infographics with AI

Slide size · Grid · Shapes · Icons · Type · Colour · SmartArt · Charts · AI

Key concepts

- Visual hierarchy uses scale, position, contrast, spacing and alignment to guide the reader through one intended path.
- PowerPoint is the editable refinement layer for AI-generated structure, imagery, text, shapes, SmartArt, native charts and Excel-linked data.
- The Microsoft 365 Copilot app can generate an infographic from a detailed prompt and, where available, approved uploaded content for grounding.
- Every AI-assisted output needs source verification, privacy review, brand control, accessibility checks and editable hand-off.

Activity 3 — Create a Timeline Infographic with Microsoft 365 Copilot

Objective: Create a timeline infographic in the microsoft 365 copilot app, then preserve hierarchy, editability, brand and evidence in powerpoint.

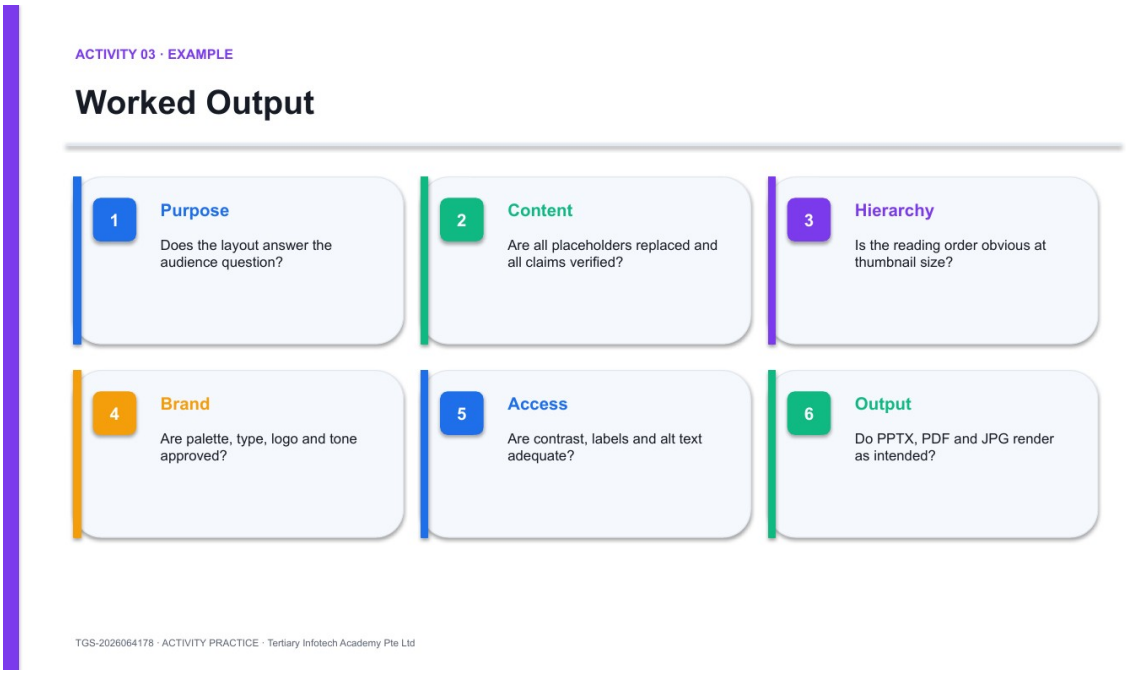
Output: An editable five-milestone timeline infographic in PPTX, PDF and JPG (40 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar HR needs a five-milestone onboarding timeline for managers: account request, manager plan, Day 1 orientation, Day 7 skills check and Day 30 outcome review.

Use Microsoft 365 Copilot Create > Design an infographic with the supplied structured prompt and approved brief. Refine the selected Wide timeline in PowerPoint; do not let generated decoration replace dated evidence.

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Activity 3 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Open Microsoft 365 Copilot —** Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app and sign in only with an approved account. Choose Create > Design an infographic. If the feature is unavailable, use the supplied editable start deck and record the fallback.
2. **Write the timeline prompt —** Copy the structured prompt from PROMPTS.md. Specify five onboarding milestones, the manager audience, the pre-boarding decision, professional style, Wide format and the approved source rule.
3. **Add approved content —** Select +Add content where available and choose only the supplied onboarding brief or workbook. Do not upload personal employee records or restricted files.
4. **Choose brand and format —** Select Brand and color where available, then choose Wide format for a presentation slide. Keep the approved blue, teal, violet and amber system.
5. **Generate and select —** Select Create, inspect the alternatives and choose the direction with the clearest chronological order. Reject any option with invented dates, labels or outcomes.
6. **Apply the approved style —** Use Design > Variants > Colors and Fonts or apply the supplied palette manually. Keep one heading font, one body font and consistent stage colours.

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7. **Check alignment —** Select comparable stage objects, then choose Shape Format > Align > Align Middle and Distribute Vertically. Group each stage after alignment.

8. **Add accessibility data —** Right-click meaningful images and choose View Alt Text. Write purpose-focused alt text; mark decorative objects as decorative where supported.

9. **Export and inspect —** Use File > Export > Create PDF/XPS for PDF and File > Save As > PNG for an image. Compare the outputs with the editable master for clipping and font changes.

Test it

Move one stage group and export a fresh PDF. Confirm connectors, labels, hierarchy, source and alt-text decisions remain correct.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Template selection and working copy
10 min	Placeholder audit and content replacement
15 min	Brand, hierarchy and alignment
7 min	Accessibility and export
3 min	Save and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Template relationship matches the brief
- No placeholder text remains
- Brand and visual hierarchy are consistent
- Source and alt text are present
- PPTX, PDF and JPG render correctly

Discussion and debrief

- Why does this template fit the question?
- Which inherited element should be removed first?
- What must remain editable?
- Which export format fits each channel?

Debrief standard: The final template-based infographic is message-led, branded, accessible, source-labelled and fully editable.

Activity 4 — Create a Process Infographic with Microsoft 365 Copilot

Objective: Use microsoft 365 copilot to generate a five-stage process infographic, then rebuild decision-critical labels, shapes, connectors and smartart as editable powerpoint objects.

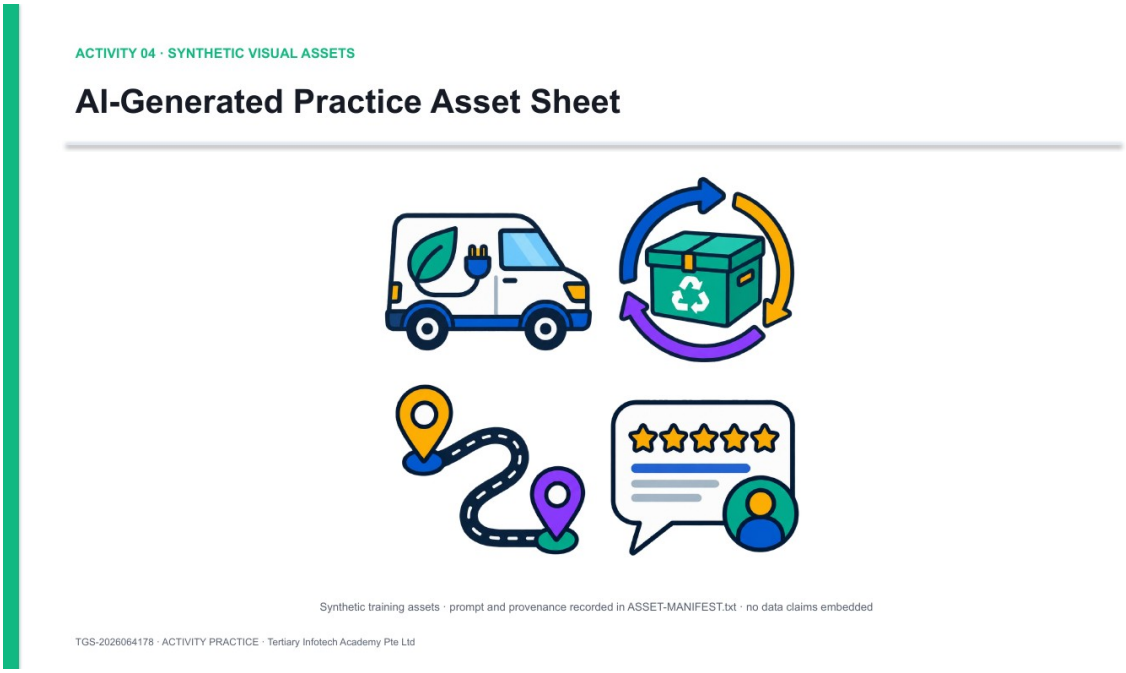
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Output: A Copilot prompt log, editable five-stage process infographic and reusable PowerPoint component slide (35 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar needs an editable five-stage sustainable-delivery process infographic for store managers. Use the supplied structured Microsoft 365 Copilot prompt and approved synthetic stage data.

Treat the Copilot output as a design direction. Build all stage names, values, connectors, source labels and decision meaning as editable PowerPoint objects.



Activity 4 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Review the source and prompt —** Open the A04 workbook and PROMPTS.md. Confirm the five approved stages, audience, decision, source note and forbidden claims before using Copilot.
2. **Generate the process direction —** In Microsoft 365 Copilot choose Create > Design an infographic. Submit the structured process prompt, add only the approved source content, choose Wide and apply the approved brand colours.
3. **Inspect before use —** Reject any result with the wrong sequence, invented facts, embedded unreadable text, ambiguous symbols or inconsistent visual grammar. Record the accepted and rejected options.

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4. **Preserve the original —** Copy or download the selected Copilot output as evidence. Work on a named PowerPoint copy so the generated direction remains available for comparison.

5. **Open the PowerPoint start file —** Save a named working copy, set guides and margins, and insert only the approved assets.

6. **Build editable information —** Create the five stage containers, titles, metrics, connectors, source notes and decision labels as native PowerPoint objects. Do not bake claims into the image.

7. **Align and distribute —** Use Shape Format > Align and Distribute. Group each stage logically while keeping text and data editable.

8. **Add accessibility —** Write purpose-focused alt text for meaningful assets, mark decorative assets where appropriate and preserve direct text labels.

9. **Complete provenance —** Record Microsoft 365 Copilot, exact prompt, date, source status, intended use, rejected output, human changes, reviewer and owner in the workbook.

Test it

Replace one Copilot-generated process direction. Confirm all facts, labels, connectors and sources remain separate, native and editable in PowerPoint.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Set grid and build first component
15 min	Duplicate, align and connect
8 min	Insert and format icons
5 min	Compare SmartArt
2 min	Save and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Stages use equal size and spacing
- Connectors remain attached when objects move
- Icons use one family and have direct labels
- The reading path is obvious
- All objects remain editable and grouped logically

Discussion and debrief

- Which visual property signals sequence?
- Where is direct labelling still required?
- Would SmartArt clarify or constrain this design?
- How will the system remain reusable?

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Debrief standard: The process uses a consistent component system, real connectors, direct labels, purposeful whitespace and editable PowerPoint objects.

Activity 5 — Create a Comparison Data Story with Copilot and PowerPoint

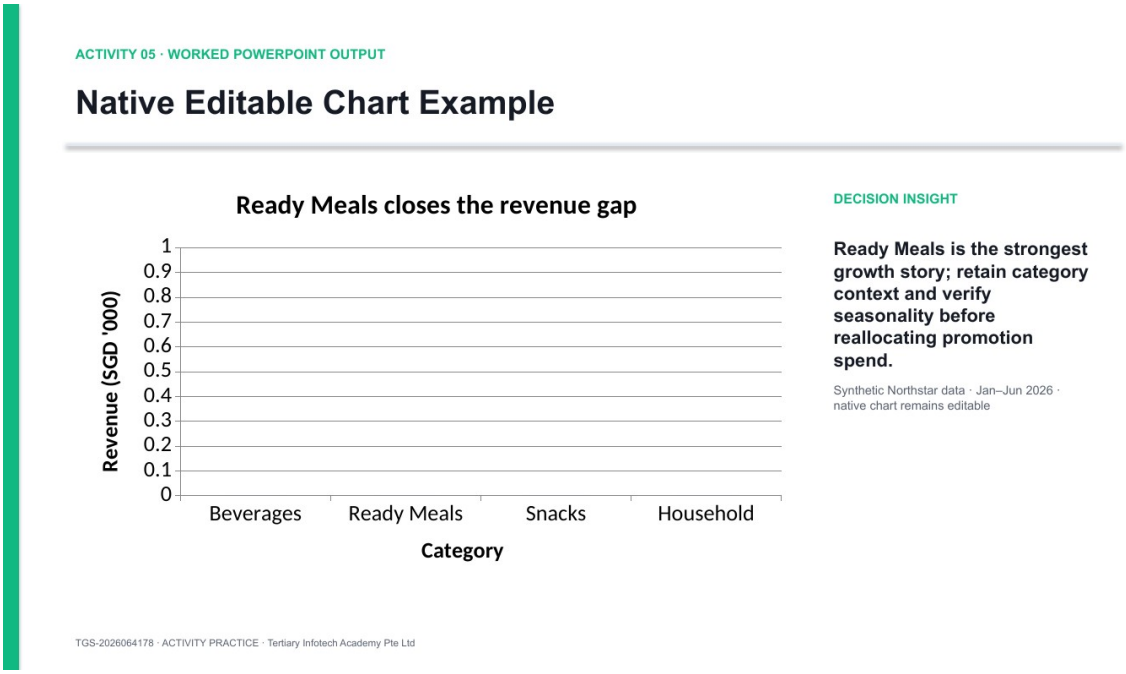
Objective: Use microsoft 365 copilot to analyse approved mock excel data, verify calculations, then create a comparison infographic with a native editable chart in powerpoint.

Output: A Copilot analysis log, verified formula workbook, comparison infographic and annotated decision slide (45 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar's marketing team must choose one product family for the next promotion. The supplied workbook contains monthly revenue, units, margin and returns for four categories.

Prompt an approved AI assistant to analyse the workbook and propose candidate insights. Reproduce the selected calculations in Excel, then create an editable PowerPoint chart with an explicit decision implication.



Activity 5 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Open and validate the workbook —** Open the A05 XLSX. Review Data, Analysis, Source Notes and AI Prompt Lab. Change one input value and confirm formulas update without errors.

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2. **Run the analysis prompt —** Ask Microsoft 365 Copilot to flag data-quality issues, compare revenue, growth, margin and returns, calculate candidate metrics and cite the relevant rows. Require no invented values.

3. **Verify every calculation —** Reproduce the selected growth, totals, averages and comparisons with Excel formulas. Record any rejected AI claim and why.

4. **Define the decision metric —** State which product family to promote and the minimum evidence required. Separate observed patterns from hypotheses and caveats.

5. **Choose the chart —** Use a clustered bar for category comparison or a line for change over time. Explain why the chart reveals the relationship better than a pie or 3-D chart.

6. **Create the Excel chart —** Select the prepared Analysis range, choose Insert > Recommended Charts, select the intended chart, and add a precise chart title.

7. **Paste as a native chart —** Copy the chart. In PowerPoint choose Home > Paste > Use Destination Theme & Embed Workbook or Keep Source Formatting & Link Data. Do not paste as a picture.

8. **Remove chart junk —** Use Chart Design > Add Chart Element. Keep only necessary axes, direct labels and a short title. Remove background fills, 3-D effects, unnecessary gridlines and legends.

9. **Write the action title —** Replace the topic title with a sentence that states the supported conclusion, for example Ready Meals combine the fastest Q2 growth with above-floor margin.

10. **Highlight the decision —** Use one accent colour for the selected category. Keep all comparison categories neutral and add one concise annotation.

11. **Add source and limitation —** Show Synthetic Northstar data, Jan-Jun 2026 and one relevant caveat such as promotional seasonality or return-rate uncertainty.

12. **Test refresh and log —** Change one workbook input, refresh the chart and confirm the visual updates. Complete the AI prompt/source log with tool, prompt, output, verification and owner.

Test it

Change one Excel input, refresh the native chart and verify the action title, direct labels, unit and limitation against the updated data.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
8 min	Validate data and define metrics
10 min	Build the Excel chart

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15 min	Paste and format the native chart
8 min	Write insight, source and limitation
4 min	Refresh test and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Workbook has zero formula errors
- Chart type matches the relationship
- Action title states a defensible insight
- One accent highlights the decision
- Source, timeframe, unit and limitation are visible

Discussion and debrief

- Which metric answers the actual business question?
- What does the chart show that a table does not?
- Which context or caveat belongs on the slide?
- Which product should be tested and why?

Debrief standard: The chart is native/editable, uses an appropriate form, retains source context and makes a proportionate product-promotion recommendation.

Activity 6 — Create a Hierarchy Infographic with Microsoft 365 Copilot

Objective: Generate a source-grounded business-goal hierarchy in microsoft 365 copilot and refine it as an accountable editable powerpoint master.

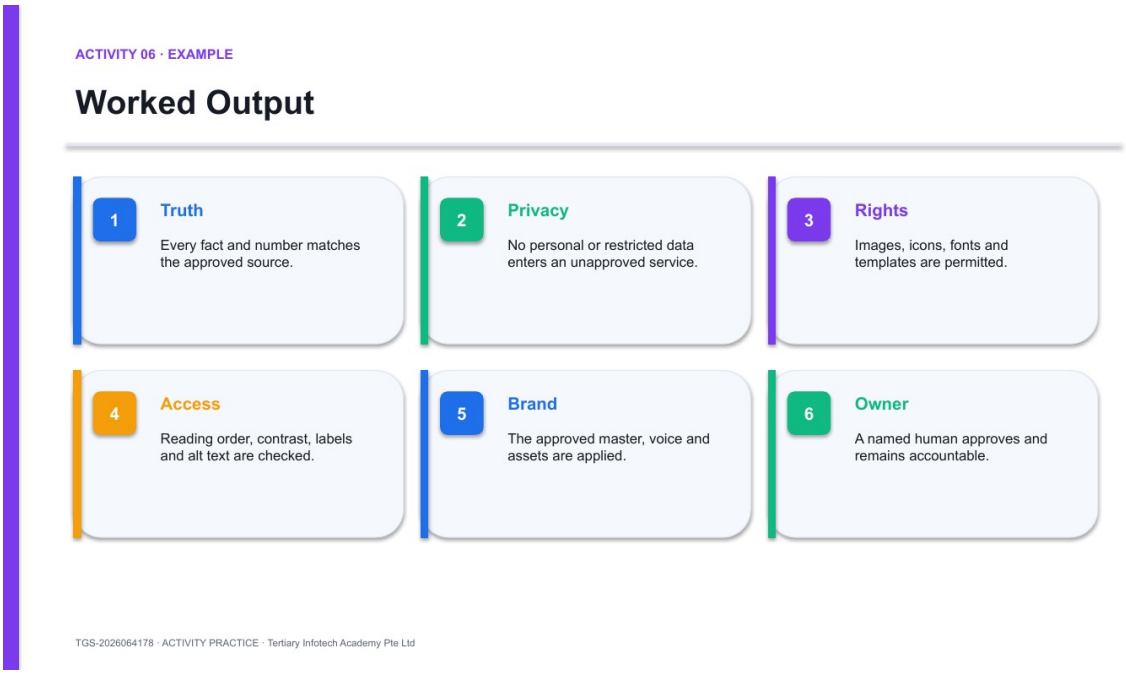
Output: Two Copilot hierarchy directions, a reviewed editable PowerPoint hierarchy and a prompt/source log (45 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar wants an executive hierarchy infographic connecting its service-trust goal to a recovery outcome, a four-hour measure, the customer-operations owner and a monthly review.

Use Microsoft 365 Copilot with the approved strategy note to create two hierarchy directions. Verify the relationships, then rebuild the selected direction as an editable PowerPoint hierarchy.

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Activity 6 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Open the hierarchy brief —** Open the A06 workbook, PROMPTS.md and source-pack folder. Complete the audience, business goal, outcome, measure, owner, review cadence, approved sources and forbidden claims.
2. **Run the Copilot route —** In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app choose Create > Design an infographic. Add the approved strategy note where available, submit the hierarchy prompt, choose Wide and apply the approved brand colours.
3. **Generate two directions —** Request two hierarchy alternatives: a top-down tree and a cascading goal-to-owner flow. Preserve both outputs unchanged as evidence.
4. **Score the hierarchy —** Use the workbook to score relationship accuracy, source grounding, hierarchy, editability, brand, accessibility and business usefulness.
5. **Verify every relationship —** Compare every goal, outcome, measure, owner and review statement with the approved source pack. Reject any inferred target or ownership statement that is not supported.
6. **Refine in PowerPoint —** Choose the stronger direction. Rebuild decision-critical text, connectors and levels as native objects; apply brand, source footer, alt text and correct reading order.
7. **Test the chain —** Ask a peer to read from goal to review and explain the logic. Revise any ambiguous connector or level, then export PDF and compare it with the editable master.

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8. **Record ownership —** Complete the prompt/source log with selected sources, both Copilot outputs, rejected claims, human changes, reviewer and final owner.

Test it

Read the hierarchy from business goal to review cadence. Trace every level to the approved source and document any relationship Copilot inferred incorrectly.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
7 min	Complete the structured prompt
8 min	Generate two hierarchy options
10 min	Score and verify
15 min	Rebuild and check accessibility
5 min	Complete log and submit

Acceptance checklist

- Both hierarchy directions use the same approved brief and source scope
- Goal, outcome, measure, owner and review logic are visible
- Every claim matches the source pack
- Critical evidence is editable in the final PowerPoint
- Prompts, human changes, reviewer and owner are recorded

Discussion and debrief

- What must the prompt include to prevent a generic output?
- Which data cannot be sent to an unapproved service?
- What must be rebuilt as native PowerPoint objects?
- Who signs off the final infographic?

Debrief standard: The final slide records the prompt, sources and human changes; all claims are verified and the decision evidence remains editable.

LU3 — Evaluating and Presenting Infographics for Business Impact

Story · Context · Simplicity · Coaching · Budget · Effectiveness · Improvement

Key concepts

- Effective review separates message clarity, data integrity, visual hierarchy, accessibility, audience fit and business usefulness.
- Coaching uses specific observations, questions and criteria rather than taste-based comments such as 'make it pop'.
- Tool investment is evaluated through capability, licence, learning, production, governance, collaboration and maintenance costs.

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- Improvement is evidence-led: gather feedback, prioritise changes, revise the controlled master and retest the intended outcome.

Activity 7 — Create and Review a Stakeholder Mind Map Infographic

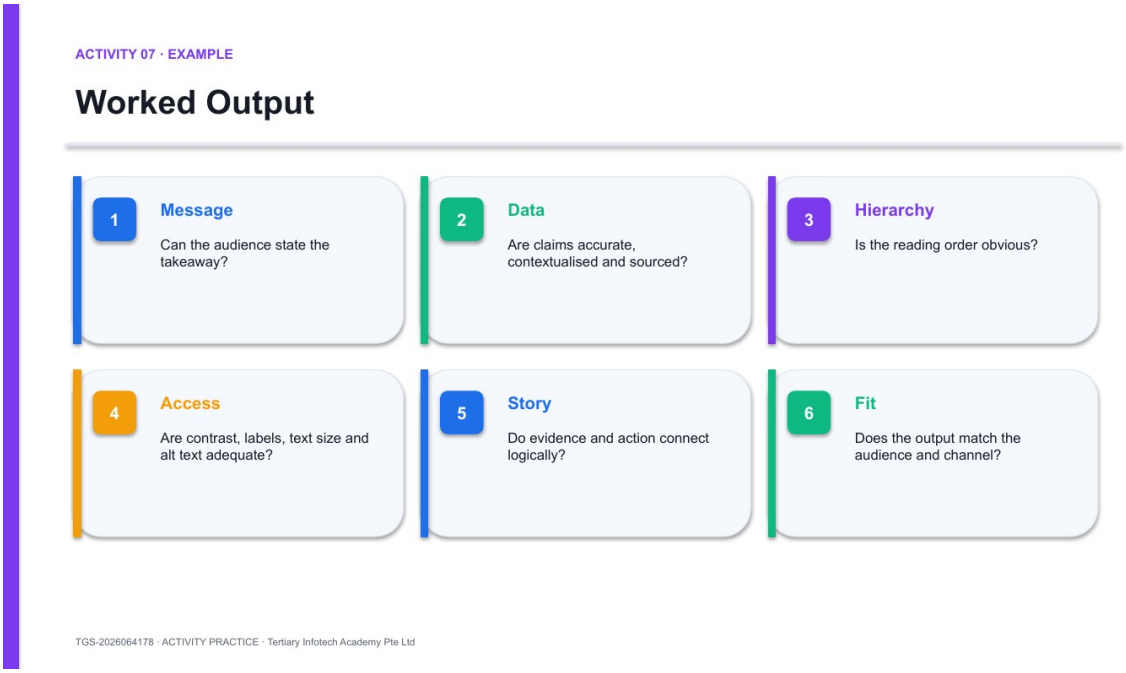
Objective: Create a stakeholder mind map, give criteria-based feedback and revise it to improve clarity, story and accessibility.

Output: A stakeholder mind map infographic, completed peer-review log, revised PowerPoint and short reflection (30 minutes).

Scenario

Each learner uses Microsoft 365 Copilot to draft a stakeholder mind map linking executives, managers, analysts, staff and customers to one common decision story.

Present the editable PowerPoint mind map to two peers. Capture two observations, two strengths, two improvements and one agreed revision, then retest the reading path.



Activity 7 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Roles

- Designer — Goal: explain the intended audience and message. Listen without defending every choice; ask for evidence.
- Reviewer — Goal: give criteria-based feedback. Use observations, questions and one prioritised suggestion.
- Audience representative — Goal: test comprehension. State what you understood, what confused you and what action you would take.

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Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Generate the mind map —** Use Microsoft 365 Copilot to draft a stakeholder mind map linking executives, managers, analysts, staff and customers to one decision story. Preserve the prompt and generated option.
2. **Create the review slide —** Rebuild the selected mind map as an editable PowerPoint slide, with direct labels, purposeful connectors, a source note and one central decision.
3. **Assign roles —** Work in groups of three: Designer, Reviewer and Audience representative. Rotate roles if time permits.
4. **Run the five-second test —** Show the slide for five seconds, then hide it. The audience representative states the message, evidence and intended action they remember.
5. **Record observations —** In A07-Peer-Coaching-and-Story-Review-Data.xlsx capture visible facts only: reading order, text size, labels, contrast, source, chart comprehension and action clarity.
6. **Ask clarifying questions —** The reviewer asks which audience, message, evidence and constraint drove the design. The designer answers without dismissing the observation.
7. **Apply the six-lens rubric —** Score Message, Data, Hierarchy, Accessibility, Story and Channel fit. Add one evidence note for every score.
8. **Prioritise one change —** Choose the issue with the largest audience or decision impact. State the change, owner and acceptance check.
9. **Revise the master —** Update the editable PPTX. Do not flatten the file or create an uncontrolled duplicate.
10. **Retest and reflect —** Repeat the five-second test and write 150-250 words on what improved, what remains and why.

Test it

Generate the stakeholder mind map, then repeat the five-second audience test before and after revision. Record the observed change in recall, reading order or action clarity.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Assign roles and run five-second test
10 min	Observe, question and score
8 min	Prioritise and revise
5 min	Retest

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2 min	Save reflection

Acceptance checklist

- Feedback contains observations, not taste-only comments
- Every score has evidence
- One high-impact change is prioritised
- Revised PPTX remains editable
- Reflection explains how the change affects audience understanding

Discussion and debrief

- What did the audience understand first?
- Which issue has the greatest decision impact?
- Which feedback is evidence-based rather than taste?
- How will the change be tested?

Debrief standard: The review log contains observed evidence, a principle-based diagnosis, one prioritised change, a named owner and an acceptance check.

Activity 8 — Create a Resource Scorecard Infographic

Objective: Compare infographic-tool investment options and recommend a resource plan using effectiveness and governance criteria.

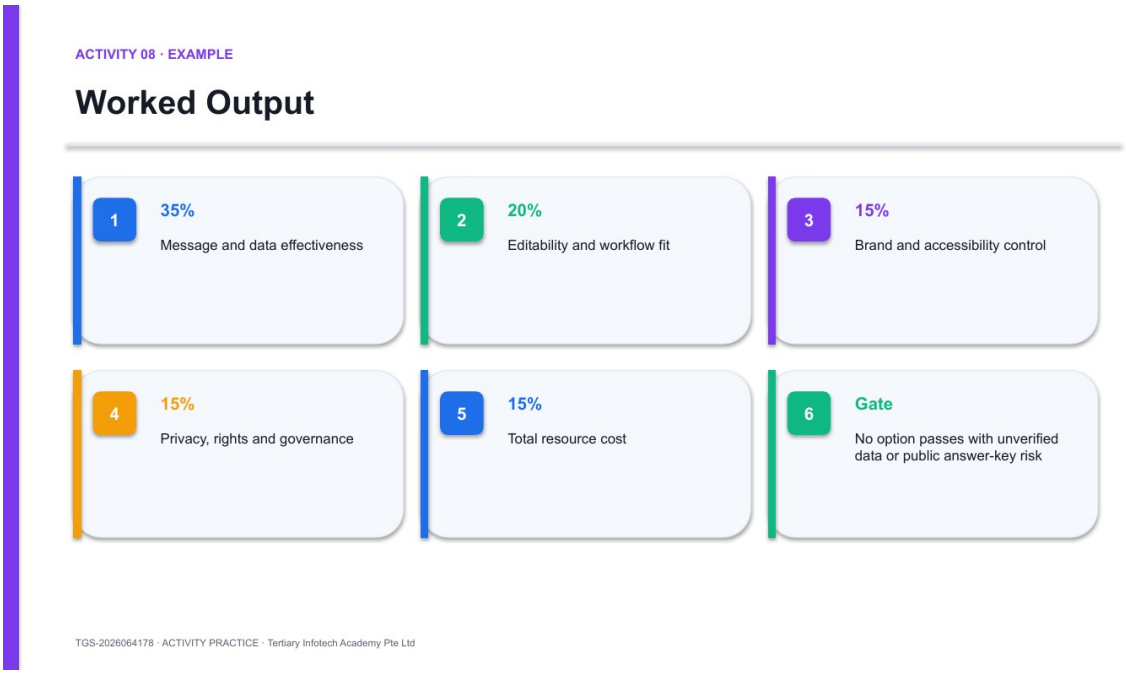
Output: A weighted resource-scorecard infographic and one-page workflow recommendation (30 minutes).

Scenario

Northstar can fund one standard workflow for 12 staff. Options include PowerPoint templates only, PowerPoint with Microsoft 365 Copilot, a Copilot-first governed workflow, or a mixed approved workflow with PowerPoint as the controlled final-production layer.

Use the supplied budget workbook and effectiveness evidence to recommend a 12-month tool, training and governance plan aligned with business outcomes.

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Activity 8 workflow/output preview — use the editable PPTX in the activity folder.

Detailed step-by-step procedure

1. **Open the options workbook —** Open A08-Budget-and-Effectiveness-Decision-Data.xlsx and review Assumptions, Options, Scorecard and Recommendation.
2. **Confirm the business need —** Record the number of users, infographic volume, required channels, approved data classification and business outcome.
3. **Review total resource cost —** Check licence, training, production, review, governance, maintenance and estimated rework costs. Do not compare licence fees alone.
4. **Set decision weights —** Use the supplied weights or adjust them with a written rationale. Keep effectiveness and hard governance gates visible.
5. **Score each workflow —** Score PowerPoint templates, PowerPoint + Copilot, Copilot-first governed workflow and Mixed approved tools + PowerPoint using the same scale and evidence.
6. **Test hard gates —** Mark any option that fails data handling, rights, editability, accessibility or continuity as Not eligible regardless of weighted score.
7. **Review formulas —** Confirm weighted totals and 12-month costs recalculate. Resolve any #REF!, #DIV/0!, #VALUE!, #N/A or #NAME? error before proceeding.

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8. **Write the recommendation —** In the Recommendation sheet name the preferred workflow, 12-month budget, training plan, governance controls, owner, success metrics and review date.

9. **Create the decision slide —** Open A08-Budget-and-Effectiveness-Decision-Start.pptx and add a native comparison chart, key trade-offs and one explicit recommendation.

10. **Challenge the decision —** Ask which evidence could reverse the choice. Record the trigger and the date for the formal review.

Test it

Change one decision weight or hard-gate result. Confirm eligibility, weighted score, 12-month cost and recommendation respond as intended.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Confirm need and assumptions
10 min	Review cost and score options
7 min	Apply hard gates and validate formulas
6 min	Write recommendation and decision slide
2 min	Challenge and submit

Acceptance checklist

- All options use the same criteria and scale
- Total cost includes hidden resource costs
- Governance gates override weighted score
- Workbook has zero formula errors
- Recommendation names budget, controls, metrics, owner and review date

Discussion and debrief

- Which business outcomes define effectiveness?
- What hidden resource costs could reverse the decision?
- Which risks are hard gates rather than weighted preferences?
- When should the investment be reviewed?

Debrief standard: The recommendation names the preferred workflow, budget, ownership, governance controls, success metrics and review date.

Quick PowerPoint Reference

Task	Ribbon path / method
Change orientation	Design > Slide Size > Custom Slide Size
Show layout aids	View > Ruler, Gridlines, Guides
Align and distribute	Select objects > Shape Format > Align

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Manage object order	Home > Select > Selection Pane
Insert icons	Insert > Icons
Insert SmartArt	Insert > SmartArt
Create chart	Insert > Chart, or copy from Excel and choose an embed/link paste option
Add alt text	Right-click object > View Alt Text
Check accessibility	Review > Check Accessibility
Export PDF / image	File > Export or File > Save As

Sources and Further Reading

- Microsoft Support: Create an infographic with the Microsoft 365 Copilot app: https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/create-an-infographic-with-the-microsoft-365-copilot-app
- User-provided Microsoft 365 Copilot shared prompt example: https://m365.cloud.microsoft/chat/share/eyJzaGFyZUlkIjoiMjlmMmExZWUtMjU2Zi00NTU2LWFlYmUtYjNiNGI0MzNkODE3IiwiY29udmVyc2F0aW9uSWQiOiI2NjU1YjBkMi03MDEzLTQxMzgtYjAyOS1jZGY5NmRkNTY2NmYifQ%3D%3D
- Microsoft Support: Edit with Copilot in PowerPoint: https://support.microsoft.com/en-US/PowerPoint/edit-with-copilot-in-powerpoint
- Microsoft Support: Add a slide from a file with Copilot in PowerPoint: https://support.microsoft.com/en-US/PowerPoint/copilot/add-a-slide-from-a-file-with-copilot-in-powerpoint
- Microsoft Support: Create a new presentation with Copilot in PowerPoint: https://support.microsoft.com/en-gb/copilot-powerpoint
- Microsoft Support: File formats supported by Microsoft 365 Copilot: https://support.microsoft.com/en-US/Microsoft-365-Copilot/file-formats-supported-by-microsoft-365-copilot
- Microsoft Support: Add or remove chart titles: https://support.microsoft.com/office/add-or-remove-titles-in-a-chart-4cf3c009-1482-4908-922a-997c32ea8250
- Microsoft Support: Add alternative text: https://support.microsoft.com/office/add-alternative-text-to-a-shape-picture-chart-smartart-graphic-or-other-object-44989b2a-903c-4d9a-b742-6a75b451c669
- Microsoft Support: Make presentations accessible: https://support.microsoft.com/office/make-your-powerpoint-presentations-accessible-to-people-with-disabilities-6f7772b2-2f33-4bd2-8ca7-dae3b2b3ef25
- Microsoft Support: Change slide size: https://support.microsoft.com/office/change-the-size-of-your-slides-040a811c-be43-40b9-8d04-0de5ed79987e
- Microsoft Support: Align or arrange objects: https://support.microsoft.com/office/align-or-arrange-objects-bfd91078-2078-4b35-8672-f6270690b3b8
- Microsoft Support: Insert icons: https://support.microsoft.com/office/insert-icons-in-microsoft-365-e2459f17-3996-4795-996e-b9a13486fa79

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- Microsoft Support: Use charts and graphs: https://support.microsoft.com/office/use-charts-and-graphs-in-your-presentation-c74616f1-a5b2-4a37-8695-fbcc043bf526
- Microsoft Support: SmartArt graphics: https://support.microsoft.com/office/learn-more-about-smartart-graphics-6ea4fdb0-aa40-4fa9-9348-662d8af6ca2c
- W3C: Understanding Success Criterion 1.4.3 Contrast: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/contrast-minimum.html
- Datawrapper Academy: What to consider when creating charts: https://academy.datawrapper.de/article/127-what-to-consider-when-creating-charts

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